

Super Achievers



NEERJA BIRLA

FOUNDER &
CHAIRPERSON
OF ADITYA BIRLA
EDUCATION TRUST

Mental health is an issue very close to Neerja Birla's heart. Through Mpower—the initiative from the Aditya Birla Education Trust (ABET)—the objective is to create awareness among children on mental health at a young age, only to ensure they can face up to it better. In spite of all the efforts, there is still a stigma around the issue in India, a challenge that Birla needs to counter. A report from ABET says close to 150 million Indians grapple with stress, anxiety and depression but less than 25% seek help.



NIGAR SHAJI

ASSOCIATE DIRECTOR—PROJECTS,
UR RAO SATELLITE CENTRE
(URSC), ISRO; PROJECT DIRECTOR,
ADITYA-L1

Nigar Shaji has spent over three decades at ISRO working across satellite engineering, systems integration and mission planning. She has contributed to multiple communication and remote-sensing satellite projects. She served as Project Director for Aditya-L1, India's first solar observatory mission, overseeing the spacecraft's development. Known for her systems engineering experience, Shaji has been part of teams that manage mission interfaces across payloads.



PHOTO BY BANDEEP SINGH



NITA AMBANI

FOUNDER & CHAIRPERSON,
RELIANCE FOUNDATION

Nita Ambani wears many hats. She is a philanthropist, educationist, businesswoman, a patron of the arts and sports. Perhaps no role is as important as that of Reliance Foundation's Chairman. Set up in 2010, it aims to build an inclusive India. This is through a holistic model to counter India's development challenges. Reliance Foundation has touched the lives of over 86 million people in upwards of 91,500 villages. At the foundation, the thrust is on improving the quality of life of those in the marginalised and vulnerable communities.